

01

DAYS 1-21

RECRUITER DISCOVERY

OBJECTIVE

Identify the narrow recruiter segments with the sharpest early-career hiring pain.

KEY ACTIONS

Interview 20 recruiters / hiring owners

Collect last-hire artifacts: resumes, portfolios, job descriptions, rubrics

Map screening pain, trusted signals, and unusable signals

Identify which proof types matter per role

SUCCESS METRIC

Top 3 recruiter ICPs with active hiring pain and willingness to review candidates.

DECISION GATE

Continue only with segments where recruiters show active hiring pain and willingness to review candidates.

02

DAYS 22-45

CONCIERGE PROOF MATCHING

OBJECTIVE

Prove recruiters can shortlist candidates faster through Merit-style proof.

KEY ACTIONS

Select 5 recruiter partners

Each submits 1 real role

Manually curate 10 candidates per role

Prepare structured proof summaries

Run live review sessions

Measure confidence & shortlist decisions

SUCCESS METRIC

≥30% of reviewed candidates are shortlisted or seriously considered.

DECISION GATE

If <30% shortlisted, the proof structure or candidate supply is not strong enough yet.

03

DAYS 46-65

STUDENT PROOF QUALITY

OBJECTIVE

Improve supply quality based on recruiter feedback.

KEY ACTIONS

Convert recruiter feedback into proof checklist

Identify 30 high-potential students

Each improves 1 proof card

Review before/after with recruiters

Track what changes increase confidence

SUCCESS METRIC

Recruiters mark more proof cards as "clear evidence" and confidence rises.

DECISION GATE

If students cannot produce stronger proof with simple guidance, onboarding and templates need redesign.

04

DAYS 66-90

REPEAT BUYER LOOP

OBJECTIVE

Show repeat demand and willingness to pay.

KEY ACTIONS

Ask initial recruiters for 2nd role or batch

Offer paid pilot / LOI

Track recruiter willingness to pay for: curated batch, workspace, contact unlocks, shortlist support

Capture testimonials on confidence, speed, and proof quality

SUCCESS METRIC

≥5 recruiters return or request another batch; ≥3 pay or sign LOI.

DECISION GATE

Next build cycle is based on repeated recruiter behavior, not founder intuition.

PMF SCORECARD

RATE 0-5 (HIGHER IS BETTER)

RECRUITER PULL

Retention and buying intent from recruiters.

2.5

/5

STUDENT SUPPLY QUALITY

Quality, clarity, and recruiter-readiness of student proof.

2.0

/5

MARKETPLACE READINESS

Repeatable loop, patterns, and infrastructure readiness.

1.5

/5

0-1

EARLY

2-3

PROGRESS

4-5

STRONG

NORTH STAR

Recruiter-qualified shortlists created from structured proof.

DEFINITION

A recruiter-qualified shortlist is a set of candidates a recruiter says they would interview or seriously consider after reviewing Merit proof.

WHY THIS MATTERS

When recruiters can shortlist with more confidence and speed, they return. When they return, students with real ability get discovered.

KEY INPUT METRICS

#

Students with complete proof

#

Roles submitted

#

Curated sets delivered

#

Recruiter review sessions

#

Shortlists created

CONFIDENCE DELTA

+X.X

Avg recruiter confidence before vs after proof